MEETING MINUTES

Women's Enterprise, SACCO & Cooperative Development

DRAFT / FOR VALIDATION AND APPROVAL

MEETING	Women's Enterprise, SACCO and Cooperative Development Meeting
DATE	Not recorded in the handwritten notes
TIME	Not recorded
VENUE	Busika, Luwero District — inferred from the notes; to be confirmed
ORGANISATION / SACCO	Not stated clearly in the notes
CHAIR / RECORDER	Not recorded
ATTENDANCE	Group members and visitors; a full attendance list was not supplied
DOCUMENT STATUS	Draft for validation and approval

PURPOSE

To discuss women's enterprise and wine production, SACCO development and registration, PDM and GROW opportunities, and cooperative governance.

A KEY SPEAKERS AND SPEAKING ORDER

NO.	SPEAKER	ROLE / AFFILIATION	SESSION
1	**Executive Director (ED)**	Name not recorded	Welcome and communication; explicitly identified as the first speaker
2	**Kalyowa Geofrey**	District Commercial Officer (DCO), Luwero District	Address, training and responses to questions
3	**Nyakain Grace**	Gender — role as written in the notes	Training session listed after the DCO's session
4	**Jonathan Sselubiri**	Uganda Cooperative Alliance (UCA)	Cooperative and SACCO training

Name spellings are reproduced from the handwritten notes and should be checked against the attendance list.

B RECORDED AGENDA

Preliminary activities also included registration of group members and visitors, and reading of the programme.

1	Opening prayer.
2	Welcome and communication from the Executive Director.
3	Introduction of members and visitors.
4	Training/address by the District Commercial Officer.
5	Training by Nyakain Grace (listed as "the lady" in the programme).
6	Lunch break.
7	Training by the Uganda Cooperative Alliance (UCA).
8	SACCO registration.
9	Closing prayer.

1.0 PRELIMINARY PROCEEDINGS

1.1 Opening and registration

The programme provided for an opening prayer, registration of group members, arrival and registration of visitors, and reading of the programme.

The Executive Director welcomed the visitors and introduced the SACCO to the District Commercial Officer. Members were subsequently introduced individually.

2.0 COMMUNICATION FROM THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

2.1 SACCO development and organisational coordination

The ED reported on her meeting with Salim Saleh and explained that she had presented a concept aimed at improving the SACCO.

She emphasised equality within the organisation and explained the process for borrowing money from the SACCO, noting that the process could strengthen coordination among members.

She raised a concern about the district's engagement in Busika and discussed efforts to access Parish Development Model (PDM) funding for women. The specific district concern was not elaborated in the notes.

2.2 Wine production, GROW and enterprise expansion

She discussed banana wine production and processing, as well as expanding activities referred to in the notes as "CUF" in different areas to improve living standards. The acronym has been retained as written and requires confirmation.

She reported that the organisation had secured a GROW project and that engineers had visited to prepare bills of quantities.

She discussed the need for donor support for pineapple wine production and separate machinery, noting that banana and pineapple production could not be combined.

She encouraged women to expand from the mother branch and replicate similar projects in their villages.

She indicated that participants were expected to begin earning income from wine production in December. The year was not specified.

2.3 Marketing, digital support and financial skills

The ED called for training in marketing, supported by digital devices that would help members market the wine they produce. She appealed for resource persons to assist with the training.

She also emphasised the need to teach members accounting skills.

3.0 ADDRESS BY THE DISTRICT COMMERCIAL OFFICER — KALYOWA GEOFREY

3.1 Roles, decentralised services and local visibility

The DCO outlined the offices and responsibilities under his docket, including PDM and tourism, and emphasised holistic development through the different departments.

He supported Busika having its own commercial officer and bringing government services closer to the people, including services for farmers and fisheries.

He observed that the organisation was not well known in Busika and emphasised the need for stronger visibility and outreach.

3.2 Government support and SACCO registration

He stated that government supports community initiatives, citing "CUF" as an example, and discussed SACCO registration and linkage to the wider cooperative movement.

3.3 Questions, taxation and production support

Participants were advised to maintain close contact with government offices so that they could remain informed.

The notes refer to electricity support from the Ministry of Energy for production centres and to Uganda Revenue Authority (URA) tax matters, including a possible grace period for businesses. The conditions were not fully recorded and should be verified with the relevant offices.

3.4 PDM repayment and marketing points

The PDM notes record a two-year grace period, repayment beginning in the third year, additional interest where repayment extends beyond three years, and an interest amount of UGX 60,000. The basis for this amount is not stated.

The discussion also emphasised setting appropriate prices, collective marketing, and grouping items for pricing.

All PDM terms and figures above are recorded as heard and must be checked against current official guidance before being relied upon.

4.0 GENDER SESSION — NYAKAIN GRACE

4.1 Record of the session

Nyakain Grace is listed as the third key speaker, with "Gender" recorded as her role. The programme also lists a training session by "the lady" immediately after the DCO's session.

The handwritten notes do not contain a clearly separated account that can be reliably attributed to her. No specific statement or decision has therefore been assigned to her in this draft; this section should be completed or confirmed before approval.

5.0 COOPERATIVE TRAINING — JONATHAN SSELUBIRI, UCA

5.1 Role and structure of the cooperative movement

The UCA representative described the Alliance as a national umbrella body that brings SACCOs and cooperatives together. He outlined the primary, secondary, tertiary and apex levels, identifying the apex as the overall umbrella level.

5.2 Registration, probation and compliance

He explained that a group passes through a preparation/probation stage and is monitored for compliance before receiving a final certificate.

He noted that certification may be withdrawn if the organisation fails to follow cooperative requirements, including in cases involving misuse of authority. Cooperative rules were to be applied carefully and members were expected to comply with the law.

5.3 Leadership and governance

Members were advised to choose effective leaders who could mobilise others and to review the group's progress from its establishment to its current position. The SACCO was described as a business requiring committed members and serious leadership.

Leadership training, elections and changes in leadership were discussed. A four-year leadership term was mentioned; this should be checked against the SACCO's approved bylaws.

The group was advised to involve or consult the DCO on leadership and registration matters. Where the DCO is unavailable, a representative may be sent. Registration documents and resolutions were to be discussed with the DCO before submission to the registrar.

5.4 Membership, shares and registration requirements

The requirements listed included national identification (NID) for every member, voluntary participation, compliance with the law, business capital, and payment of membership fees and omugabo (shares).

Membership money was described as supporting group mobilisation, while shares were identified as business capital and not funds for salaries or unrelated expenditure.

The notes state that registration should be supported by a resolution and refer to more than 30 members, bylaws/regulation books, four copies, a UGX 20,000 subscription/share amount connected with the head office, and payment of UGX 60,000 to the ministry.

The exact basis of the UGX 20,000 charge and the applicability of the other figures are not fully clear. All requirements, amounts and copy numbers should be confirmed with the DCO/UCA before payment or submission.

5.5 Member services, finance and GROW

The session also covered member qualification, enterprise education for women, microfinance, market access, and coordination with the ministry regarding export licensing.

The notes link an association certificate with improved access to finance and record an interest rate of 6% per annum. The particular loan or financial product to which this rate applies is not identified.

The GROW discussion emphasised women organising under cooperatives to access government support. Taxation of individuals in different sectors was also mentioned.

6.0 WINE PROCEEDS AND REGISTRATION OUTCOME

6.1 Sharing of wine proceeds

The agenda provided for the different women's groups to agree on how to share proceeds from wine production. No agreed formula or formal decision was recorded.

6.2 SACCO registration

SACCO registration appeared in the programme after the UCA training. The notes do not confirm whether registration was completed during the meeting or whether the item was limited to guidance and preparation.

7.0 CLOSURE

7.1 Closing programme

The programme included a lunch break and entertainment, and concluded with a closing prayer and departure at leisure. No closing remarks, adjournment time, next meeting date or additional closing decision was recorded.

8.0 PROPOSED FOLLOW-UP ACTIONS

RECORD CAVEAT No separately worded resolutions or voting outcomes appear in the notes. These are proposed follow-ups arising from the discussions, not confirmed meeting decisions. Leads and deadlines must be confirmed.

NO.	ACTION	SUGGESTED LEAD — TO CONFIRM	TIMING
1	Prepare the SACCO registration file, including the resolution, member/NID list and bylaws; consult the DCO before submission to the registrar.	SACCO leadership with DCO	Not recorded
2	Verify the registration and governance figures: membership threshold, UGX 20,000, UGX 60,000, number of bylaw copies and leadership term.	SACCO leadership with UCA/DCO	Before payment or submission
3	Follow up implementation of the GROW project and the engineers' bills of quantities.	ED / Project team	Not recorded
4	Seek donor or partner support for pineapple wine production and appropriate machinery, while keeping banana and pineapple processes separate.	ED / Project team	Not recorded
5	Organise digital marketing and accounting training, and assess the need for digital devices and resource persons.	ED with partners	Not recorded
6	Confirm current PDM eligibility, grace-period, repayment and interest terms, and support eligible women to access the programme.	DCO / SACCO leadership	Before applications
7	Develop and document a transparent method for sharing wine proceeds among the women's groups.	Women's group representatives / SACCO leadership	Not recorded
8	Strengthen the organisation's visibility in Busika and follow up closer access to commercial, agricultural and fisheries services.	DCO / Local leadership	Not recorded
9	Develop collective marketing and group pricing, and explore market linkages and guidance on export licensing.	Members with DCO/UCA	Not recorded
10	Support women to replicate suitable enterprise projects at village level and expand beyond the mother branch.	ED / Women's group leaders	Not recorded

9.0 ITEMS REQUIRING CONFIRMATION BEFORE APPROVAL

- Meeting date, start/end times, venue, convening organisation/SACCO name, chair and recorder.
- Full attendance list and the Executive Director's name.
- Exact spelling of speaker names, particularly "Nyakain Grace" and "Jonathan Sselubiri".
- The meaning of the acronym "CUF" and the unclear organisation name in the DCO notes.
- A standalone record or confirmation of Nyakain Grace's presentation.
- The year attached to the expected December income from wine production.
- All legal, registration and financial figures, including UGX 20,000, UGX 60,000, more than 30 members, four copies, four years and 6% per annum.
- Whether SACCO registration was completed, and whether any formal resolutions were adopted.

10.0 REVIEW AND APPROVAL

PREPARED BY	REVIEWED BY — ED	APPROVED BY — CHAIR
Name / Signature: _____	Name / Signature: _____	Name / Signature: _____
Date: _____	Date: _____	Date: _____

Source and method: Prepared from six supplied images containing handwritten notes and a key-speaker list. The content has been reorganised by speaker and subject. Unclear wording has not been presented as verified fact.